(v) To defend the socialist motherland

(vi) To render military service

(vii) To respect the national dignity of other citizens

(viii) To respect the rights and lawful interests of other persons

(ix) To protect nature and conserve its richness

(x) To preserve historical monuments and other cultural values

(xi) To promote and strengthen world peace

Russian Constitution

Russia was the largest constituent unit of the former USSR. It was 75 per cent of the total area of the former USSR and had 50 per cent of its total population. It also contributed about 70 per cent to the total agricultural and industrial output of the former USSR.

After the dissolution of the USSR in December 1991, Russia adopted a new Constitution on 20 December 1993 and thus, established a new politico-administrative system.

The salient features of the Russian Constitution are mentioned as follows:

1. It declares Russia as a sovereign and multi-ethnic republican state.
2. It provides for a federal state. The Russian Federation consists of 21 Republics, 6 Territories (*Krai*), 49 Regions (*Oblast*), 10 Autonomous Areas (*Avtonomy Okrug*), 2 Cities (Moscow and St. Petersburg) of federal status, and Birobijan (Jewish Autonomous Region).
3. It establishes a liberal-democratic order and guarantees fundamental rights to the citizens. Thus, it discards the earlier totalitarian system.
4. It introduces multi-party system and ensures free and fair periodic elections.
5. It provides for the division of the State power among the legislature, executive, and judiciary. These three organs are independent of one another.
6. It establishes bicameral legislature (Federal Assembly) consisting of Federation Council (upper House) and State Duma (lower House). The Federation Council consists of 178 members, two from each territorial units of the Russian Federation. The State Duma consists of 450 members who are directly elected for a period of four years.
7. It declares President of the Russian Federation as head of the State. The President is elected for a term of four years by universal and direct suffrage. He/she is head of the executive as well as Commander-in-Chief of the armed forces.
8. It authorises the President of the Republic to appoint the Chairman of the Government as the Prime Minister. The President is to appoint other Federal Ministers on the advice of the Prime Minister. He/she can also dismiss the Prime Minister or any other Federal Minister.